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Towel

10.4 Towel

References:

Greek λέντιον (lention) JHN 13:4, JHN 13:5

Description:

The towel was a piece of cloth used primarily for drying. It would most likely have been made of cotton or linen (see 1.5.3.7 Linen<REALIA:1.5.3.7>).

Translation:

The particular piece of cloth in JHN 13:4; JHN 13:5 was large enough for Jesus to wrap around himself. The act of washing feet was normally performed by a servant or a slave. Such servants often performed their services dressed only in a loincloth (see 6.4 Loincloth<REALIA:6.4>). While it may be good to explain this fact in a footnote, the translation itself will only be able to indicate it if there is a similar piece of clothing used by servants.